



ALEXANDROS LAZARIDIS, PhD

Senior Technical Product Owner & Staff Data Engineer

15+ Years in Conversational AI, GenAI, Insights & Analytics

8180 Bülach, Switzerland · +41 79 839 76 29 · alaza@live.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Technical Product Owner and AI/Data Leader with **15+ years** bridging complex business problems and data-driven solutions. **3+ years as Product Owner** at Swisscom, owning vision, strategy, and roadmap from concept to launch for two cross-functional teams across three Conversational AI products. Currently Staff Data Engineer and Deputy Product Owner for Conv. AI, GenAI & Analytics — combining product strategy with hands-on engineering depth, and comfortable holding my own in discussions about data models, APIs, and system architecture. Former Director of Speech Processing R&D, partnering with Microsoft Research, EPFL/Idiap, and the University of Zurich. PhD in Speech Processing & ML, 40+ peer-reviewed publications, SAFe® 5 PO/PM certified.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Product Leadership & Vision** — Product strategy and roadmap; concept-to-launch ownership; data-driven backlog prioritization; KPI definition; shaping product culture
- **Stakeholder Liaison** — Primary bridge between business leaders, operators, data scientists, and engineers; aligning teams; senior stakeholder communication
- **Translating Business → Data-Driven Solutions** — Converting ambiguous business problems into well-defined product requirements, user stories, specifications, and acceptance criteria
- **AI/Data Fluency** — LLMs, GenAI, prompt engineering, embeddings, ML pipelines, eval harnesses — credible partner to data science and engineering teams
- **Technical Aptitude** — Data models, APIs, system architecture; AWS (S3, Glue, Lambda, Step Functions, Athena, Bedrock); Python, SQL; BI (QuickSight/SPICE — direct parallel to Looker/BigQuery)
- **Mentoring & Team Building** — Mentored junior product owners and engineers; SAFe® 5 PO/PM certified; supervised Master's and PhD theses across Swiss academic partners

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Staff Data Engineer & Deputy Product Owner — Swisscom, Zurich, Switzerland *Nov 2024 – Present*
Data, Analytics & AI (DNA) Group — GenAI & Conversational AI. Deputy Product Owner since Feb 2026, combining product strategy with engineering depth.

Bridge between complex operational challenges and cutting-edge AI solutions — identifying high-impact opportunities where data, AI, and automation revolutionize customer interaction, planning, and decision-making.

- Identified high-impact AI opportunities and translated ambiguous business problems into product requirements and specifications for engineering and data science teams.
- Designed and deployed LLM-powered analytics pipelines on AWS (Bedrock, Glue, Step Functions, Athena) integrating Anthropic Claude, Azure OpenAI, and on-prem / fine-tuned models.
- Established KPI and reporting frameworks (QuickSight/SPICE) used by senior stakeholders to measure product effectiveness and business impact.
- Acted as primary liaison between product leadership, business stakeholders, data scientists, and engineers — driving alignment across data models, APIs, and system architecture decisions.
- Owned production-grade governance: cost/latency monitoring, PII redaction, access controls, and auditability.
- Mentored engineers, trainees and Master's students on LLM pipelines, evaluation harnesses, and data engineering best practices.

Led 2 cross-functional teams (engineering, ML, analytics) over 3+ years, owning three Conversational AI products from concept to launch: Swisscom Voice Assistant on TV Box, VoiceBot/Chatbot for customer self-service, and Conversational Insights for customer-needs understanding.

- Owned product vision, strategy, and roadmap — aligning senior stakeholders, market trends, and customer needs into a clear plan from concept to launch.
- Converted ambiguous business problems into well-defined product requirements, user stories, and acceptance criteria for engineering and data science teams.
- Managed a data-driven product backlog, prioritizing features and initiatives that delivered the highest business value.
- Defined and monitored KPIs to measure product effectiveness, impact, and adoption across customer-facing channels.
- Served as primary liaison between business leaders, customer-care operators, data scientists, and engineers — ensuring alignment and clear communication across all teams.
- Held my own in technical discussions on data models, APIs, and system architecture; partnered with engineering on feasibility, scope, and risk mitigation.
- Mentored junior product owners and engineers on Agile/Scrum, product ownership, and stakeholder management.

Director — Speech Processing R&D — Swisscom, Zurich, Switzerland*Sep 2017 – Jul 2022*

Led the Speech Processing R&D group, defining research direction and partnering with leading academic & industry institutions: Microsoft Research (Munich), EPFL/Idiap, University of Zurich (UZH), HEFR Fribourg.

- Steered R&D portfolio across ASR (Swiss German dialects), language ID, speaker verification, emotion/sentiment analysis, TTS, NLP/NLU, neural machine translation, and active learning.
- Supervised and co-supervised Master and PhD theses across Swiss academic partners.
- Established multi-year collaboration with Microsoft Research on Swiss German ASR.
- Led “Fairness in AI” research initiative with University of Zurich.

Research Associate — Idiap Research Institute, Martigny, Switzerland*Oct 2015 – Aug 2017*

Speech synthesis & prosody modelling (SIWIS / Swiss NSF), multilingual ASR (SUMMA / EU H2020), and ASR for Swiss German dialects (Swisscom partnership).

Post-doctoral Researcher — Idiap Research Institute, Martigny, Switzerland*Nov 2012 – Oct 2015*

SIWIS (Spoken Interaction With Interpretation in Switzerland): prosody modelling, regional accent identification, emotional/affective modelling, and statistical parametric speech synthesis (HMM/DNN) in English, German and French.

Post-doctoral Researcher — University of Patras, Patras, Greece*Nov 2011 – Oct 2012*

Prosody modelling of neutral and emotional speech; statistical parametric speech synthesis approaches.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIA

- PhD, Speech Processing & Machine Learning — University of Patras (Jan 2011)
- Engineering Diploma (BSc & MSc), Electrical, Electronics & Communications Engineering — Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (Sep 2005)
- Certified SAFe® 5 Agile/Scrum PO/PM — Flow Sphere AG (Jul 2021)
- 40+ peer-reviewed publications since 2005 (15+ journal articles & book chapters, 25+ international conference papers).
- Lecturer at Technological Educational Institute of Thessaloniki and University of Western Macedonia; Teaching Assistant at University of Patras (Digital Signal Processing, Informatics, Digital Design, Speech Technology).

LANGUAGES

- Greek (C2) · English (C2) · German (A1, learning)